



Windows update bug

This Windows 10 update bug is so bad that it can potentially destroy your SSD with frequent defrags. <http://digit.in/sep20-45>



AI Top Gun

In the US Military AlphaDogfight challenge, an AI system successfully took down a human fighter pilot. <http://digit.in/sep20-46>

RDNA2 cards are expected to have a 50 per cent performance-per-watt improvement over RDNA1 which is massive. Dubbed “Big Navi” and the “NVIDIA Killer”, the upcoming RDNA2 graphics cards are expected to give NVIDIA a run for their money and that’s why we’re seeing massive gaps in the RTX 30 lineup. The moment AMD announces their RDNA2 desktop graphics cards or once there’s

enough credible information in the market, we should see NVIDIA react and fill the gaps with more graphics cards that are competitive or better. That’s when we’ll see the Ti cards, or silicon-forbid, Super cards.

The RDNA2 graphics cards are expected to launch in November 2020, so that’s a few months after the RTX 30 launch. I know AMD has disappointed us all in the past

with their attempts at making a high-end flagship graphics card in the form of Radeon VII but the RX 5700 XT was a great follow-up and if we’re looking at a 50 per cent improvement over RDNA1, then RDNA2 could very well be AMD’s comeback into the big leagues. So hold off on all your graphics card upgrades, let’s wait a few more months and go with the winner. **A**

BUYING ADVICE

LAPTOP OR DESKTOP?

Q Dear Agent001, I am Kanishk Joshi and I have been reading your magazine for the past 3 years. My father is looking to purchase a new pc for his recruitment consultancy business. We are confused between buying a laptop or configuring a desktop. We are looking for something durable, fast, good storage and good for eyes. My concern is – a laptop comes in a small size and desktop comes in a large size so hardware components assembled in a laptop are very close to each other they will heat a



ASUS VivoBook

lot and over a period of time its lifetime will decrease. Desktop does not heat much as hardware components assembled in a desktop are not that close to each other compared to laptop. Our budget is ₹70-80K for the hardware.

–Kanishk Joshi

A Hey Kanishk, You are right about closely placed components losing life owing to higher

heat generation. However, this is a problem that has been tackled by hardware manufacturers years ago. They handle this by making components for laptops more energy efficient. Desktop components are often designed with higher TDP (Thermal Design Power) limits whereas laptop components or mobile components are designed with a lower TDP. The heat generated by laptop components is significantly lower. This also means that the frequency of the processor has to be reduced to meet the TDP target. So laptop components will not perform as good as desktop components. The lower TDP along with the cooling designed for laptops is enough to make them last for 3-5 years easily, if taken care of.

I’d assume that the applications that you father will use for his work aren’t CPU intensive. Emails, spreadsheets, word documents and a few browser sessions are what’s typically involved. For such applications, you don’t need to spend a lot of money. You can make do with laptops that sell in the ₹40-50K price range. Laptops such as the Lenovo Ideapad Slim 3i, Dell Vostro, Acer Aspire 5 and ASUS Vivobook with the Intel Core i5-10210U processor should fit in your budget and perform great.

JACK OF ALL HEADPHONES

Q I am thinking about buying a new pair of headphones for my personal use. I intend to use it primarily with my PC, for gaming, listening to music, and some video editing.



JBL Quantum 800 gaming headset

I have boiled down my options to 2 models – the JBL Quantum 800, and the Sony WH-1000XM3. The Q800 has both 2.4GHz and Bluetooth connectivity. It’s also got a more PC-centric feature set, with a boom mic, and volume wheels, etc. But on the other hand, the XM3 has superior sound quality and ANC (or so I’ve heard). I am a little worried about the latency on the XM3 though.

–Soham Dafadar

A Hey Soham, You’ve got yourself into a bit of a pickle here. Each have their own fair share of pros and cons. The Sony WH-1000XM3 are more casual-listening, commute-friendly headphones while the JBL Quantum 800 live and breathe gaming. While the Bluetooth connectivity on the Quantum 800 is nothing to write home about, the 2.4GHz connectivity is extremely stable and mostly latency-free. Additionally, you get access to JBL’s feature-laden software. When using the Sony WH-1000XM3 on PC, you won’t be able to access the Sony | Headphones Connect app (for phones) which has tons of customisability options.

The latency on the Sony WH-1000XM3 is pretty jarring if you’re coming from using wired headsets or 2.4GHz gaming headsets. The included 3.5mm wire is a solution that Sony provides, but the wire is not too long. We’d suggest you to go for the JBL Quantum 800. You can always tweak the sound to your preference via the JBL software. **A**